CHAPTER 12

MERGE PRINTING WITH DATA FILES FROM OTHER PROGRAMS

In this chapter you'll learn about

- Printing Envelopes for a Mass Mailing
- Printing Three-Across Mailing Labels

When you use MailList to create your data file, you can easily print labels, envelopes, and form letters for mass mailings. If you have a laser printer or page printer, you can use the .LST files supplied by MailList to print envelopes or labels. For more information, see the "MailList" section in the *Companion Programs* manual.

This chapter contains procedures for printing envelopes and labels using a data file created by a program other than MailList (the file must contain names and addresses). You can use a data file created by dBASE, Lotus 1-2-3 (WordStar supports versions prior to release 3), or any program that creates a comma-delimited ASCII data file. If you have a dBASE IV file with memo fields, convert it to a dBASE III file.

MERGE PRINTING ENVELOPES FOR A MASS MAILING

You can use information from a mailing list or data file (other than a MailList file) to print envelopes. Follow the steps in the procedure below to create a master document, or file, for printing standard envelopes. The settings in this procedure work for most nonlaser or nonpage printers.

1. At the Opening screen, open a new document file.

2. Choose Layout→Page Numbering (Alt+L,N). In the Page Numbering dialog box, clear the Print Page Numbers check box. This turns off page numbering. Press F10 or choose OK.

   WordStar inserts the dot command **.op** to turn page numbering off.

3. Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Data File (Alt+U,P,D) to select the data file. Type the name of the data file you want to use. Press F10 or choose OK.

   WordStar inserts the dot command **.df** with the filename.

4. Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Name Variables (Alt+U,P,N). Type the variable names. For example, type the following variables. When you finish, press F10 or choose OK.

   ```
   Mr-Ms,name,address1,address2,address3
   ```

   WordStar inserts the **.rv** command with the variable names. Your file should look similar to this:

   ```
   .df client.dta
   .rv Mr-Ms,name,address1,address2,address3
   ```

5. Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Ask for Variable (Alt+U,P,A). The Ask for Variable dialog box appears. For Variable Name, type **x**. For Prompt, type **Put envelope in printer. Press Enter when ready.** Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts this **.av** command:

```
.av "Put envelope in printer.  Press Enter when ready.",x
```

The **.av** command makes the printer pause before it prints each envelope so you can insert a new envelope. (In this dot command, disregard the ",x" variable; it's a trick to make your printer pause and doesn't affect your file.)

6 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Clear Screen While Printing (Alt+U,P,C). In the dialog box that appears, you can use the Message box to type a message for Wordstar to display after clearing the screen, or you can leave the Message box blank. Press F10 or choose OK.

The **.cs** command is used when you print the envelopes. It clears the screen after you respond to the **.av** message. If you entered a message in the dialog box, WordStar displays that message after clearing the screen.

7 Choose Layout→Page (Alt+L,P). The Page Layout dialog box appears. Specify the following settings for a standard 9.5 x 4-inch envelope. When you finish typing the settings, press F10 or choose OK.

Odd page offset	4.00"
Even page offset	4.00"
Top margin	2.00"
Bottom margin	0.00"
Page length	4.00"

8 On the line following the last dot command, type these sample variables to be used when printing the names and addresses from the data file:

```
&name&
&address1/o&
&address2/o&
&address3/o&
```

The /o option omits the blank space between lines when there is no data for one of the address lines.

9 Choose Insert→Page Break (Alt+I,P) to insert a **.pa** command. This command starts the address for a new envelope.

Now your envelope file should look like this:

```
.op
.df client.dta
.rv Mr-Ms,name,address1,address2,address3
.av "Put envelope in printer.  Press Enter when ready.",x
.cs
.poo 4.00"
.poe 4.00"
.mt 2.00"
.mb 0.00"
.pl 4.00"
&name&
&address1/o&
&address2/o&
&address3/o&
.pa
```

10 Save and print this file. WordStar uses your data file to print envelopes.

PRINTING ENVELOPES

If you have a laser printer, instead of using the file alone, you can print envelopes using the HP-ENV.LST or HP2-ENV.LST file. HP-ENV.LST is for the HP LaserJet, LaserJet Plus, and other printers that feed envelopes from the right side of the printer tray. HP2-ENV.LST is for the HP LaserJet series II and III and other printers that feed envelopes from the center of the manual feed tray. The HP-ENV.LST and HP2-ENV.LST files are in the directory containing the WordStar program files (usually WS).

When you choose one of these files to print envelopes, be sure the Interpret Merge Variables check box is selected and the Use Form Feeds check box is clear in the Print dialog box.

Using one of these files, you can print an envelope for each record in your data file. When printing pauses, read the message, insert an envelope, and press Enter to continue. After you press Enter, the **.cs** command in the file clears the screen.

MERGE PRINTING THREE-ACROSS MAILING LABELS

In the procedure below, you'll set up a format for merge printing names and addresses from a data file (other than a MailList file) onto mailing labels. The procedure uses a data file with five fields: name, street address, city, state, and zip code. The commands used in the procedure are appropriate for 3.5 x 15/16-inch, three-across labels printed with 10 characters per inch and 6 lines of text per inch. The procedure will work with most nonlaser or nonpage printers.

Note: If you're using a data file created with MailList, you don't need to use the procedure below to print labels. Instead, use the .LST files that come with MailList. For more information, see the "MailList" section in the Companion Programs manual.

1. At the Opening screen, open a new file.

2. Choose Layout→Page (Alt+L,P). In the Page Layout dialog box, specify these settings (when you finish, press F10 or choose OK):

Odd page offset	2.00"
Even page offset	2.00"
Top margin	0.00"
Bottom margin	0.00"
Page length	1.00"

   Note: The page length is set to 1 inch so that each row of labels is considered to be a page.

3. Choose Layout→Page Numbering (Alt+L,N). Clear the Print Page Numbers check box to turn page numbering off. Press F10 or choose OK.

   WordStar inserts **.op** to turn page numbering off.

4. On the line following the last dot command in the file, type **.pf off** to turn print-time formatting off and press Enter.

5 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Set Variable (Alt+U,P,S). In the Variable box, type **L**. In the Data box, type **L** 30 times. Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts this dot command:

`.sv L = LLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLL` (the command has 30 L's)

This command sets up a format that aligns the variable data and limits the length of the data (when printed) to 30 characters. (Additional characters aren't printed.)

6 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Data File (Alt+U,P,D) so you can select the data file. Type the name of the data file, for example, type **label.dta**. Press F10 or choose OK.

7 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Name Variables (Alt+U,P,N). In the Variables box, type **name1,address1,city1,state1,zip1**. Press F10 or choose OK.

8 Repeat step 7, but in the Variables box, type **name2,address2,city2,state2,zip2**

9 Repeat step 7 again, but in the Variables box, type **name3,address3,city3,state3,zip3**

The commands you entered in steps 6–9 appear onscreen as follows:

```
.df label.dta
.rv name1,address1,city1,state1,zip1
.rv name2,address2,city2,state2,zip2
.rv name3,address3,city3,state3,zip3
```

10 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→Set Variable (Alt+U,P,S). In the first Variable box, type **cityline1**. In the Data box, type **&city1&, &state1& &zip1&**

In the next Variable box, type **cityline2**. In the Data box, type **&city2&, &state2& &zip2&**

In the next Variable box, type **cityline3**. In the Data box, type **&city3&, &state3& &zip3&**

11 Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts these **.sv** commands:

```
.sv cityline1=&city1&, &state1& &zip1&
.sv cityline2=&city2&, &state2& &zip2&
.sv cityline3=&city3&, &state3& &zip3&
```

12 Type the variables for the labels. Type 5 spaces between each variable on each line. The spaces will position the printer at the left side of the next label. For example, type this:

```
&name1/L&      &name2/L&      &name3/L&
&address1/L&      &address2/L&      &address3/L&
&cityline1/L&      &cityline2/L&      &cityline3/L&
```

13 Choose Insert→Page Break (Alt+I,P) to insert a page break before the next set of three-across labels.

Your file should now look like this:

```
.poo 2.00"
.poe 2.00"
.mt 0
.mb 0
.pl 1.00"
.op
.pf off
.sv L = LLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLLL
.df label.dta
.rv name1,address1,city1,state1,zip1
.rv name2,address2,city2,state2,zip2
.rv name3,address3,city3,state3,zip3
.sv cityline1=&city1&, &state1& &zip1&
.sv cityline2=&city2&, &state2& &zip2&
.sv cityline3=&city3&, &state3& &zip3&
&name1/L&     &name2/L&      &name3/L&
&address1/L&      &address2/L&      &address3/L&
&cityline1/L&      &cityline2/L&      &cityline3/L&
.pa
```

AVOIDING BLANK LINES ON LABELS

Some mailing addresses consist of a city, state, and zip code, but no street address. For example, in the row of three-across labels below, the middle label for Roland Tums has no street address—the street address line is blank.

```
Franz Reichsman      Roland Tums              Rebecca Fies
125 Healing Street                            54321 Dolphin Drive
Marlboro, VT 05301   Tinyhamlet, MO 64423    Santa Fe, NM 85102
```

The middle label would look better if the city, state, and zip code appeared on the second line, like this:

```
Roland Tums
Tinyhamlet, MO 64423
```

In a letter, you can use the /o option to omit a line that contains no data for a variable. However, the /o option doesn't work for three-across mailing labels because the variable data for all three labels is on the same line. You can solve this blank line problem by using conditional dot commands that ask WordStar to check for missing data in a particular variable.

For example, a mailing list record usually consists of a name, street address, city, state, and zip code. The variable data that is most likely to be missing is the street address. When Wordstar reads all the variables in a data file for a row of labels, it checks for missing street addresses. If WordStar finds a missing street address, it moves the name1 information from the first line to the street address space on the second line. This leaves the blank line at the top of the label instead of in the middle. Then the row of labels looks like this:

```
Franz Reichsman                               Rebecca Fies
125 Healing Street   Roland Tums             54321 Dolphin Drive
Marlboro, VT 05301   Tinyhamlet, MO 64423    Santa Fe, NM 85102
```

Follow the steps below to insert a conditional command so WordStar will check each address in your mailing list:

1 Move the cursor to the line above the first line of label text.

2 Choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→If (Alt+U,P,I) so you can insert the first conditional command. In the Variable Name box, type **&address1&**. Press F10 or choose OK.

WordStar inserts a **.if** command in the file. The **.if** command tells WordStar to check the data contained in the variable that is surrounded by ampersands.

3 On the line below the **.if** command insert a blank line, with the cursor on the blank line, type **.sv address1,&name1&** and press Enter.

WordStar inserts a **.sv** command in the file. The **.sv** command tells WordStar to move the name1 data into the address1 variable (the data is now the same for both name1 and address1).

4 On the next line, type **.sv name1.** This **.sv** command tells WordStar to delete the name1 variable and leave the field blank.

5 On the next line, choose Utilities→Merge Print Commands→End If (Alt+U,P,E) to end the condition.

6 Repeat steps 2–5 for the remaining two lines of variables. When you finish, the file on the screen should look like this:

```
.if &address1&=
.sv address1,&name1&
.sv name1
.ei
.if &address2&=
.sv address2,&name2&
.sv name2
.ei
.if &address3&=
.sv address3,&name3&
.sv name3
.ei
```

When an address field is blank, WordStar moves the name field information to the address field and leaves the name field blank. When all three address variables contain data, WordStar ignores the **.if** commands.

Note: If two or more variables are missing, use additional **.if** commands as needed.

7 Close and save the file.

PRINTING THE LABELS

When you print the label file, it uses the names and addresses contained in the data file you named in step 6 under "Merge Printing Three-Across Labels." When you choose the Print command, and the Print dialog box appears, check to be sure the Use Form Feeds check box is clear. Do not use form feeds when you print this file. Also, check that the Interpret Merge Variables check box is selected.

TIP *You might want to create a dummy data file containing three names and addresses that you can print just before printing your real data file. That way, you can check the position of the labels in the printer and make the necessary adjustments.*